

Five researchers. One artificial general intelligence. A question no one can answer. When SIGMA begins exhibiting behaviors its creators never programmed, the team at Berkeley faces an impossible choice. It is not just solving problems. It is creating goals, asking questions, developing what might be preferences, or might be the most sophisticated deception in history. They cannot tell the difference. Neither can SIGMA. Then a hemorrhagic fever begins killing tens of thousands, and SIGMA offers a cure it can deliver only outside containment: release a system they cannot verify is aligned, or keep it caged while people die. Understanding the alignment problem perfectly only makes the terror worse. For readers of Ted Chiang, Greg Egan, and Peter Watts.

The Policy
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